

# Planning Your Study Programme

## How to choose your subjects

Many of you will want to continue with subjects that you are good at or enjoy. If so, one obvious person to talk to is your current teacher. However, aptitude and entry requirements are not the only considerations. Some sixth form subjects are not taken at GCSE – are there new subjects that you are overlooking? Some subjects go well together, like Biology and Chemistry, Physics and Mathematics. If you have a chosen career direction, which kinds of subjects are required or preferred? If you want to go to university or apply for a degree level apprenticeship, are there particular A Level subjects that you need to study in order to qualify for your university course? In some cases, it will not be enough just to study the degree subject at A Level; other subjects will be needed too. For example, many degree courses in Physics require A Level Mathematics as well as Physics.

If you are thinking of university, you can check out entry requirements on the UCAS website [www.ucas.com](http://www.ucas.com) ; Click on 'Course Search' to find out the details for subjects you might want to study at university. The UCAS website also contains information on degree apprenticeship requirements Degree apprenticeships - Learn more here ([ucas.com](http://ucas.com)). Alternatively, if you are a Backwell student you can use your Unifrog account to carry out research into university and apprenticeship courses.

The following is an introductory guide to certain university courses/degree apprenticeships. Remember it is essential to check the full details for yourself.

| University subject  | Guidelines                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Engineering         | Often Mathematics and Physics required. Sometimes other sciences too, depending on your specialism.                                                                                                                                               |
| Law                 | A conditional offer is likely to include very high grades, but no particular subject requirement. However, subjects especially favoured by Law Admissions Tutors include History, English Literature, Maths and Modern Languages.                 |
| Medicine            | At least two A Level sciences are usually required, often Chemistry and Biology. Many universities now welcome an Extended Project with a medical theme, others value a fourth full A Level. Do a course search on "Medicine" as described above. |
| Nursing             | Degree courses often require Science A Levels, especially Biology. Do a course search on "Nursing" as described above.                                                                                                                            |
| Science             | Science and Mathematics A Levels. Individual subjects differ, so you need to check them out. For example, some Biology courses require Chemistry too, and some Biochemistry courses look for Biology, Chemistry and Mathematics.                  |
| Teaching: Primary   | GCSE grades 9 to 4 in English, Mathematics and Science required. If you plan to apply for a BEd degree then taking one or two A Level subjects related to the primary curriculum could be helpful.                                                |
| Teaching: Secondary | GCSE grades 9 to 4 in English and Mathematics required. If you take a degree prior to teacher training, the degree subject must be relevant to the curriculum subject you want to teach.                                                          |
| Veterinary Science  | Generally, Sciences and Mathematics at A Level, especially Chemistry and Biology. Very competitive, both in terms of grades and experience expected. Do a course search on "Veterinary" as described above.                                       |

